

Of course, if that makes you fantasize about having a luxurious untethered life by spending few hours a day penning down your thoughts, you're fooling yourself. Despite what it looks like, writing is hard work. You have to love what you do, else life will soon start to feel like self-inflicted punishment. Even if you do love writing, doing it because you have to is an entirely different experience from doing it just because you like it. Though there are many good things to be said about freelance writing as a way to make money, it is all too easy to only imagine the top. The reality of writing is, like with any pursuit, mostly the climb. If it still sounds like a good idea to you, read on, we're here to help make your climb as efficient as possible.

The requirements

You don't need a college degree to be a freelance writer. Heck, you don't even need to be done with school. Of course, if you're focusing on a particular niche and aim to be highly valued within that field, the degree will certainly help. What you need to be a freelance writer, is a solid understanding of business goals. Anyone with a basic education can write. For someone to be remunerating you for your writing, you have to be providing them with value. If this value is personal, psychological or parenthetical, your remunerator is your fan. This is the case for all the famous (and not so famous) authors that you have heard of (and many more that you haven't). They are rewarded for their writing because people find entertainment or emotional value in it. In this case, you are putting your work out there but payment is not guaranteed. This is not necessarily writing for a living as much as writing for art, and it is certainly not functional freelance writing.

When it comes to functioning as a freelance writer, you are usually not writing directly for your readers. You are (or will be) creating content for an intermediary business, who is your client. It is foremost to them that you are providing value, of some combination of the following types -

- **Deep dabbling dexterity:** In the best case scenario, you're already an expert in some sought-after domain, and you will be paid to simplify and share that knowledge. However, most writers do not have deadly domain expertise, and yet know what they are writing about. Here's the secret - You don't necessarily need a PhD in [insert topic] to write about it, but you certainly need PhD level research skills. Think about how a true geek obsesses on every component while deciding on a PC build.. As a freelance writer, you need to use that level of obsession on demand. Note this down if you have to - the most fundamental skill you